JAMESCLEMENT ONYEKACHI UGWU

Health | Agriculture | Finance

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Academia: https://independent.academia.edu/JamesClementUgwu | **Google Scholar:** https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=QJjcBtUAAAAJ

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE:

I am an early-career interdisciplinary researcher with expertise in qualitative and quantitative research, data analysis, applied econometrics, and evidence synthesis. I am committed to transforming data into actionable evidence for informed decision-making, institutional strengthening, and sustainable impact through interdisciplinary research, innovation, and ethical leadership. My Field spans Health, Agriculture, and Finance **(HAF),** with research interests encompassing Sustainability, Equity, Optimization, and Security **(SEOS).** I believe that rigorous research should extend beyond academic publication to strengthen institutions, foster transparency and accountability, improve lives, and advance sustainable development.

Research Philosophy: My work is guided by RETIRE, a self-developed framework prioritizing Rigorous, Evidence-driven, Transparent, Impact-Oriented, Reproducible, and Ethically responsible research. The framework aligns with UNESCO's open science principles to guarantee robust and universally accessible scientific outcomes.

EDUCATION

SOUTH DAKOTA STATE UNIVERSITY (SDSU). **Brookings, USA.**

Programme: *Masters of Sciences (M.Sc.), Economics. (Deferred)* 2025 – Current.

Specialization: General Economics (major) Deferred.

Minors: Health, and Econometrics.

Research Assistantship Award Recipient August 2025 – September 2026.

- Awarded admission into the M.Sc. Economics programme
- Awarded a competitive Research Assistantship
- Programme Commencement deferred due to evolving USA-Nigeria visa-related circumstances.

UNIVERSITY OF NIGERIA, NSUKKA (UNN). **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**

Programme: *Bachelor of Sciences (B.Sc.), Economics.* (2016-2020-21).

Qualification/Honours: *Upper Second (Magna cum Laude)* June 2021.

Selected Coursework: Mathematical Economics, Statistics, Applied Statistics & Econometrics, Advanced Statistics & Econometrics, Computing Applications for Economists, Business Finance, Business mgmt. Accounting, Research Methods & Development Economics.

RESEARCH PROFILE

Research Scope (HAF)

- **Health Economics and Public**
  a) Tropical Diseases b) Epidemiology c) Cost-Effectiveness Analysis d) Maternal and Child Health and e) Vulnerable Populations.
- **Agricultural Economics**
  a) Precision Agriculture b) Food Security c) Agricultural Productivity d) Climate-Smart Agriculture e) Rural Development
- **Financial and Monetary Economics**
  a) Quantitative Finance b) Capital Markets c) Financial Inclusion d) Digital Assets, Decentralized Finance (DeFi) and Blockchain Economics e) Monetary Policy Analysis.

Methodological Expertise, Quantitative & Computational Skills

- **Econometrics**
  a) Linear Regression (OLS, ARDL, Time-Series, Cross-Sectional, and Panel-Data) Analysis. b) Logistic Regression Analysis (Binary, Ordered, and Multinomial Logit) models. c) Probit and Tobit models. d) Duration Models (Count Model analysis, Negative Binomial estimation, and Survival Analysis.
- **Evidence Synthesis**
  a) Systematic Reviews b) Meta-Analysis c) Scoping Reviews d) Bibliographical and Scientometric Analysis e) Prisma and Frameworks Reporting.
- **Statistical Inference and Predictive Analytics**
  a) Parametric and non-parametric testing (t-tests, ANOVA, Chi-Square, Mann-Whitney tests) b) SOTA trend/stationarity tests (Augmented Dickey Fuller; ADF, Mann-Kendall, KPSS) tests c) Forecast Diagnostics (Diebold-Mariano, Ljung-Box) d) Mathematical Expected values (Geometric mean, Harmonic mean, Winsorization, and Weighted Average).
- **Market Research, Business Strategy, and Financial Modelling**
  a) Mapping & Market Sizing – Total Addressable Market; TAM, Serviceable Addressable Market; SAM, and Serviceable Obtainable Market; SOM b) Competitive Benchmarking (DCF valuation and WACC modelling using Aswath Damodaran datasets. c) SOTA Risk Analysis (Monte Carlo simulations, Scenario (what-if) analysis, Sensitivity analysis and d) Strategic Planning Frameworks (SWOT analysis, PEST/PESTLE analysis, and Porter's Five Forces).
- **Survey and Data Collection Tools**
  a) Online survey forms (Survey Monkeys, Google Forms, Microsoft Forms) b) Enterprise Survey Platforms (Qualtrics XM, LimeSurvey, SurveyCTO, Open Data Kit (ODK), and Kobo Toolbox.
- **Corporate Financial Reporting**
  a) Piotroski F-Score accounting risk screening testing b) Advanced Capital Budgeting (NPV; Net Present value, IRR; Internal Rate of Return, ARR; Accounting rate of Return, MIRR; Modified Internal Rate of Return, PI; Profitability Index, Payback Period, and DPP; Discounted Payback Period c) Multi-year financial statements d) ratio analysis and forecasting.

- **Computational Database, Statistics & Financial Toolkits**
  a) Programming (SQL; for relational database queries, R, and Python b) Statistical Platforms (Stata, E-views, and SPSS c) BMC; Bloomberg Market Concepts d) Financial Analyst Workstations (Capital IQ, FactSet, Refinitiv Eikon) e) Google Sheets and Advanced Excel (VBA, Power Query, Pivot) f) Research Platforms and Registries (PACTR, Zenodo, PROSPERO, Zotero, SSRN, Rayyan, and OSF; Open Science Framework).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE AND INNOVATION PROJECTS

A. Enterprise Funded Projects

1. Macroeconomic and Financial Intelligence Database Development 2026 – Present.
Lead Researcher | Refine7 (Research, Finance & Investment Start-up). **Abuja, Nigeria.**

- Leading the development and compilation of a structured database containing selected macroeconomic, financial, and socio-economic time-series indicators to support investment research, economic analysis, and strategic decision-making.
- Designing data structures and analytical frameworks for monitoring economic trends, financial markets, and socio-economic indicators.

Methods/Tools: Economic Data Analysis| Time-Series Data Management| Financial Research |Data Curation.

2. Disaggregated Personal Finance Model (DPFM) Aug 2025 - Dec 2025.
Lead Researcher & Developer **Abuja, Nigeria.**

- Developed a personal financial management system that automatically allocates income across expenditure categories using predefined spending caps to promote disciplined budgeting and financial decision-making.
- Designed an interactive dashboard for monitoring income, expenditure, savings, and spending behaviour.
- Serves as an early research prototype supporting the conceptual development of "Disaggregated Banking", a proposed research framework exploring personalized financial allocation and decision-support systems.

Tools: Microsoft Excel | Financial Modelling | Dashboard Design |Data Analytics.

3. Three-Wheel Vehicle Market Economy & Feasibility Study May, 2024.
Independent Market Researcher | The Honey Badger Fund **Nationwide, Nigeria.**

- Conducted market research on Nigeria's three-wheel vehicle economy, assessing market structure, consumer dynamics, and economic opportunities within the sector.

Methods/Tools: Market Research | Sector Analysis | Consumer Behaviour Analysis.

4. Dangote Oil Refinery Strategic Appraisal November, 2022.
Research Analyst | Confidential Investment Client **Lagos - State, Nigeria.**

- Conducted a strategic appraisal of Dangote Refinery as a mega project during its final development stage for investment assessment purposes.
- Evaluated industrial significance, energy-sector implications, market positioning and sustainability impact.

Methods/Tools: Strategic Analysis| Industrial Economics | Investment Research.

5. Fintech Market Entry Research: Payment Industry Landscape in Nigeria October, 2021.
Research Analyst | Confidential German FinTech Start-up | **Nationwide, Nigeria.**

- Research on the operability of four major Nigerian payment-sector fintechs: Flutterwave, Paystack, Paga, and Interswitch with emphasis on business models, competitive positioning, regulatory environment, adoption patterns, and scalability.
- Developed strategic insights into opportunities and constraints within Nigeria's fintech payment ecosystem.

Methods/Tools: Market Research | Sector and SWOT Analysis | Consumer Behaviour Analysis.

B. Collaborative & Grant-Funded Research Projects.

1. Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH) and CIFF Partnership Funding. **Dec 2024 – Mar 2026.**
Principal Investigator | 2024 Early Career Grant Awardee **London, United Kingdom.**
Project: *Durational Evaluation of Randomized Controlled Trial (RCT) Outcomes on Trachoma Treatment and Relapse: A Study of the Largest Urban Slum in Enugu-State, Nigeria*

- Awarded £ 4996.00 (British Pounds) by RSTMH in partnership with the Children's Investment Fund Foundation (CIFF).
- Conducted quantitative evaluation of treatment efficacy and time-to-relapse by comparing WHO-recommended antibiotics (Zithromax) with other locally affordable and accessible antibiotics (Zolon and CETROXOL).
- Applied survival analysis techniques, including Kaplan-Meier estimation and log-rank testing, to evaluate relapse-free survival.

Methods/Tools: Survival Analysis| Clinical Trial Analysis |Biostatistics

2. Household Food Production and preference Analysis of WTBS Chicken-Cow Compost for Urban and Peri-Urban Backyard Cultivation. Aug 2025 – June 2026.
Principal Investigator | Independent Research Project (ICERP) |Market-Pilot Research **Abuja, Nigeria.**

- Funded $4,000 (US dollar) research grant by ICERP (own organization) for a market pilot study examining household preferences, adoption behaviour, and supply-chain dynamics of chicken-cow compost utilization.
- Designed the research methodology, reviewed literature and developed a working paper/preprint available through SSRN.

Methods: Survey Research | Preference Analysis |Applied Econometrics (SEM & Ordered Logistic Regression)

3. Collaborative Grant Proposal: Molecular Mechanisms of Liposomal Harmine-Induced Apoptosis in Triple-Negative Breast Cancer. December, 2025.
Co-Author & Methodology Co-Designer | Collaborative Research Proposal. **China.**

- Contributed to the development of a collaborative funding proposal submitted to Xinjiang Medical University.
- Developed the Research Questions, Aim, and Objectives and also designed the Methodological components for investigating molecular mechanisms through Western blot and RT-PCR analysis.
- Awarded CNY¥ 70,000.00 (Chinese Yuan) grant for the research and in-vitro experiment and analysis.

Methods: Research Design | Methodology Development | Biomedical Research Collaboration.

4. Collaborative Grant Proposal: Sino-US Competition and Modern Mercantilism: Impacts on Trade, Investment and Geopolitical Alignments in Africa **Dec** 2025 - current.
Co-Author & Methodology Designer | PhD Research Proposal Development **United States of America.**

- Co-developed a research proposal examining the effects of geopolitical competition on trade, foreign investment, and economic alignment patterns in Africa.
- Independently designed the analytical methodology and research framework.

Methods: International Political Economy| Research Design |Economic Analysis.

C. Competitive Research Projects

1. Modern Mercantilism and Artificial Intelligence in the Global Economy (Bridgewater Associates Research Challenge). ***July - Aug* 2026.**
Independent Researcher| Global Research Competition **Connecticut, USA.**

- Developed an original research paper examining the intersection between modern mercantilism, artificial intelligence, and the evolving global macroeconomic landscape.
- Investigating how shifts toward strategic industrial policy, supply-chain realignment, technological competition, and AI adoption influence international trade, investment patterns, productivity, and economic resilience.
- Prepared the study for submission to the 2026 Bridgewater Associates & Global Citizen Research Challenge, an international competition encouraging innovative research on contemporary macroeconomic issues.

Methods/Tools: Macroeconomic Analysis| International Political Economy |Trade Economics | Policy Analysis.

2. MTN Nigeria Equity Research Challenge (CFA Institute) Oct, 2020 – April 2021.
Team Lead | Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) Institute Research Challenge | **Nationwide, Nigeria.**

- Led a five-member team in developing a 30-page equity research report analysing MTN Nigeria, one of Nigeria and West Africa's largest telecommunication companies.
- Conducted financial statement analysis, industry research, competitive positioning, and intrinsic and relative valuation.
- Selected among eight finalist teams nationwide to present investment recommendations at the national grand finale.

Tools: Equity Valuation| Financial Analysis | Investment Research.

3. ***Unilever PLC. Sustainability and Circular Economy Analysis.*** April, 2021. **London, United Kingdom.**

- Analysed Unilever PLC's 2019 Annual Report using Five Capitals and Circular Economy Frameworks.

Tools: Investment Research| Report Review | Business Strategy Tools/Analysis

4. CFA Institute Ethics Challenge Sep 2019 – Nov 2019.
Team Lead| University of Nigeria, Nsukka (UNN) Team. **Lagos and Abuja, Nigeria.**

- Led a four-member team evaluating ethical issues and professional conduct violations in a 250-pages document given certain financial cases.
- Applied CFA ethical standards to develop recommendations and presented findings before industry practitioners.
- Selected among seven finalist teams from 23 participating teams, that presented its final report to an audience of industry practitioners, emerging 3rd runner-up.

Methods/Tools: Financial Ethics| Case Analysis | Professional Standards.

5. **Global Creative Shock Challenge** **Vilnius, Lithuania.**
Team Lead Sept. 2018 – Dec. 2018.

- Led a team of four to undertake tasks on finance, marketing, public relations, and strategy problems of businesses.
- Selected out of 1000 participating teams as 1 of 100 that made it to the final round of the challenge.

RESEARCH OUTPUTS AND SCHORLARLY CONTRIBUTIONS

Peer-reviewed Publications.

1. **British Medical Journal (BMJ):** *Household Living Conditions and Food Insecurity in Nigeria: A Longitudinal Study During Covid-19 Pandemic* (2022) – https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2022-066810

Registered Protocols and Pre-prints (2026)

1. Durational Efficacy and Relapse of Ocular Chlamydia trachomatis Infection in Children: A Randomized Controlled Trial of Pfizer's Zithromax Versus Alternative Azithromycin Formulations in Enugu, Nigeria **Protocol: Registered on PACTR | PACTR2025066505210**
2. Household Food Production and Preference Analysis of the Willingness-to-Buy and Sell (WTBS) Chicken-Cow Compost for Urban and Peri-Urban Backyard Cultivation. | **Preprint Available (SSRN) | DOI: 10.2139/ssrn.5866123.**
3. Evaluating International Research Partnerships on AI-Driven Anti-Malarial Resistance Surveillance in Tropical Africa: A Quantitative Scientometric Analysis of Post-2020 Publications. |**Registered in OSF: https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/U38N5**

Protocols and Manuscripts Under Review

1. mHealth-Enhanced vs Traditional Prenatal Care in Rural Sub-Saharan Africa: A Meta-analysis of Randomized Controlled Trials from the COVID-19 Era. | Protocol Registered on Prospero | https://www.crd.york.ac.uk/PROSPERO/view/CRD420251235925.
2. The Linkages of Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH) Deficiencies to Antimicrobial Resistance in Trachoma Control: Cross-sectional Multinomial Regression Analysis in a Low-Resource Setting.
3. Ugwu, J.O. (2025). Age Thresholds and Food Insecurity in Nigeria: A Semi-parametric Analysis of Pre-COVID and Post-COVID Implications.

B.Sc. Dissertation |Open Source (Available on Academia & ResearchGate)

1. Climate change and Agricultural Productivity Nexus: An ARDL (Autoregressive Distributed Lag Model) Approach. | Available on: https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.15361.33121 | *Also Available on Academia Database*

Policy Briefs

Strengthening Trachoma Control in Enugu State: Evidence-Based Policy Recommendations from a Randomized Controlled Trial.
Submitted to:

- Enugu State Ministry of Health, Enugu-State Government.
- Enugu State Ministry of Budget and Planning, Enugu-State Government.
- National Population Commission, Enugu-State Office.
- Enugu-State Waste Management Authority (ESWAMA).

Technical Reports

Grant Technical Report (approximately 80 pages) on Durational Evaluation of Randomized Controlled Trial Outcomes on Trachoma Treatment and Relapse. Submitted to:

- Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH).
- Children's Investment Fund Foundation (CIFF)

Others (Notable Mentions)

- . Farmer Adoption of Precision Livestock Farming in US: Current and Future States; **Research paper prepared for academic assessment associated with South Dakota State University.**

WORK AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

3PA Services **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Founder & Executive Director March 2026 – Present

- Founded and lead a 7-division third-party agency covering executive and virtual assistance, visa and flight services, graduate programme services, consultancy, remote gigs placement, and remote system maintenance and cloud services.
- Recruit, train, and manage 11+ remote contract team members against performance targets of 40,000 points monthly.
- Designed a 4-document onboarding system (Offer letter, company profile, NDA form, and bio-data form] for new hires.

Refine 7 (Research, Finance, Investment and Data Analysis) **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Founder, Executive Director. Launching April 2027.

- Founder of Refine 7, a start-up that is building proprietary global data platforms on markets, economies, and consumer opinion.
- Developing 3 flagship portals, Findex Voxdex, and Ecodex, to give people and businesses better research and advisory services.
- To offer secondary macroeconomic and financial data brokerage and analytical services for customers (individuals and businesses).

ICERP (Independent Centre for Experiments, Research, and Programmes) **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Founder/Lead Researcher. March 2023 – Present

- Guided 30+ M.Sc. and Ph.D. students on research conceptualization and methodology design, working with researchers and scholars of varying ranks across academic institutions.
- Led a small team of young scholars constituting the not-for-profit small-scale think tank, offering independent research services and grant proposals writing for solving public health and socio-economic issues.

Freelance Remote Gigs (Fiverr, Mercor, and Mindrift) **Remote, Worldwide.**
Annotation and RLHF Specialist (AI-trainer) August 2024 – Present

- *RLHF and Model Tuning:* Specialized in Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF) through reward model training.
- *Advanced Annotation*: Expertise in complex Data Labelling, Prompt Engineering, and creating comprehensive Evaluation Rubrics for model alignment.

National Accounts, Energy and Environmental Statistics Division (NAESSD),
National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Graduate Special Assistant to Chief Economist & National Youth Service Corp (NYSC) Nov. 2021 – Feb. 2023.

- Successfully collated the statutory allocation and internally generated revenue of states in Nigeria.
- Successfully contributed to the retrieval of institutional periodic data from public parastatals in Abuja.
- Collaborated and partook in data outsourcing, surveys, and field trips to different states for data collection.

PARG, (Policy Analysis and Research Group) UNN **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Director of Research and Academic Planning (DRAP; elected) July 2019- August 2021

- Organized annual parliamentary policy debate, developed, and managed PARG's E-library and media repository.
- Mentored enthusiastic analysts, organized intra-university field trip,
- Successfully directed over 40 research projects and their subsequent official presentations.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Catholic Lectors Association of Nigeria *(CLAN),* Catholic Secretariat of Nigeria (CSN). **F.C.T, Abuja Nigeria.**
Chairman, Byelaw-Drafting Committee. May 2024 – August 2025.

- Led a 5-man committee inclusive of lawyers to draft a byelaw for the association.

*Chairman, **INEC (Independent NESA Electoral Commission).*** June 2021 – August 2021.

- Successfully superintended the conducting of credible election & transition of Govt. **Enugu-State, Nigeria**

*Secretary | President, **Students Board of Lectors (SBL), UNN**.* April 2018 | May 2019 – Aug. 2021.

- Successfully developed 10 years reading directory and edited a maiden reading guide.
- Increased the board's annual revenue by 63% through strategic introduction of utility pamphlets and programmes.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Happy End Academy, Odim Gate, UNN. **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Pre-College Tutor [Economics, English Language]. March 2017 – July, 2021.
• Consistently improved the performances of over 65% of students in their external tests.
*Team Lead, **Academic Tutorials, UNN.*** April 2017 – June 2021, **Enugu, Nigeria.**
Led a 4-man team that periodically organize and teach in Revision classes and tutorials for school mates.

- Personally reviewed, summarized and developed revision questions from 7 General Studies' (GS) courses for all students of UNN.
- Successfully organized and mobilized funds for fees and tuitions of indigent and bereaved course mates.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

- **Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH)** **London, UK.**
- **Policy Analysis and Research Group (PARG)** - **Nigeria**
- **Data Science Nigeria (DSN)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Statistical Association (NSA)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Economic Society (NES)** - **Nigeria**
- **Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) – (Digital member, not a charter holder)** **Nigeria.**

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS, AND EVENTS.

- **RSTMH Global Research in Progress Webinar, (Colloquium).** **Virtual, June 2025.**
- **Delegate, National Youth Confab.** October 7 – 8, 2026.
- **RSTMH Annual General Meeting & Grants Workshop.** **London, United Kingdom**.
  Equitable partnerships in Global Health October 15 – 17, 2026.
- **CFA Institute Webinar:** Harnessing AI for smarter Investment Decisions. Apr 24, 2025.

SKILLS, INTERESTS, AND AWARDS

Other soft skills: Leadership, Critical Thinking, Human management, Emotional Intelligence, Negotiation skills, Communication skills, Analytical and business skills, Logic & Philosophy, Script Writing, and Sales.

Interests: • Entrepreneurship • Football, • Travelling • Artificial Intelligence (AI) Creation • Social Media • Music and • News.

Merit Awards:

- Best Researcher [Policy Analysis and Research Group - 2021].
- Leadership Excellence [PARG, 2021].
- Leadership Excellence [SBL, 2021].
- Most Resourceful member [PARG – 2021]
- Excellence for Selfless Service [UNN, 2021]
- Best Policy Debater [PARG & NESA, 2018-2020] and More.

REFEREES

Available on Request.